Outlook

Town Meeting Resident Communication Channel

From Stephen Harrington <stephenharrington@yahoo.com>
Date Mon 9/14/2026 8:15 PM
To sbadmin <sbadmin@town.arlington.ma.us>; Jim Feeney <jfeeney@town.arlington.ma.us>; John Hurd <jhurd@town.arlington.ma.us>

CAUTION: This email originated from outside your organization. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking links, especially from unknown senders.

Dear Select Board Administrator,

Please, include this under Correspondence Received and distribute to Select Board members.

Good evening. My name was s Stephen Harrington. I live at Columbia Rd in Arlington. I want to briefly update the Board on the Town Meeting resident-access issue I raised in July.

My questions concerning the legal authority for the resident co-sign requirement remain unanswered, as do outstanding public-records requests concerning rejected submissions from 2024 and 2025.

More importantly, I want the prospective remedy clearly in the public record.

I support Arlington's effort to modernize Town Meeting, including expanded electronic and hybrid participation. But modernization should also include a neutral way for identified Arlington residents to submit germane written advocacy concerning pending warrant articles without first obtaining a Town Meeting Member sponsor.

The Town can impose objective rules for deadlines, length, format, duplication, privacy, security, and germaneness. Access should not depend on subjective judgments about tone, civility, criticism of officials, or undefined "appropriateness." Any rejection should be written and publicly logged.

As Arlington designs the next generation of electronic Town Meeting, this is the time to design resident access into that system rather than preserve sponsor-dependent access as a legacy feature.

I again ask that this issue be placed on a public agenda for discussion and action.

Regards,

Stephen Harrington

74 Columbia Road

Arlington, MA